

# Homework 7

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MATH 421 — The Theory of Single Variable Calculus  
Section 003  
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## Collaboration Statement

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**Problem 1** (*Ross Chapter 2 11.4*)

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Repeat Exercise 11.2 for the sequences:

$$w_n = (-2)^n, x_n = 5^{(-1)^n}, y_n = 1 + (-1)^n, z_n = n \cos\left(\frac{n\pi}{4}\right).$$

*Question 11.2 asks you to do the following for each sequence:*

- (a) For each sequence, give an example of a monotone subsequence.
- (b) For each sequence, give its set of subsequential limits.
- (c) For each sequence, give its  $\limsup$  and  $\liminf$ .
- (d) Which of the sequences converges? diverges to  $+\infty$ ? diverges to  $-\infty$ ?
- (e) Which of the sequences is bounded?

### Discussion.

So we will analyze each sequence one by one, finding monotone subsequences (which we know must exist by 11.4 Theorem), subsequential limits,  $\limsup$  and  $\liminf$ , convergence/divergence, and boundedness for each.

For review, here are the relevant definitions:

- (a) **Monotone subsequence:** A subsequence that is either non-increasing or non-decreasing.
- (b) **Subsequential limits:** The set of all limits of subsequences of a given sequence.

- (c) **Limit superior (lim sup):** The largest subsequential limit of a sequence.
- (d) **Limit inferior (lim inf):** The smallest subsequential limit of a sequence.

**Answers.**

For  $w_n = (-2)^n$ :

- (a) Monotone subsequence: All the even terms of the sequence form an increasing, monotone subsequence  $n$  is even,  $w_{2k}$  such that we have the terms:  $(4, 16, 64, \dots)$ . Alternatively, all the odd terms of the sequence form a decreasing, monotone subsequence  $n$  is odd,  $w_{2k+1}$  for  $k \in \mathbb{Z}^+$  such that we have:  $(-2, -8, -32, \dots)$ .
- (b)

□

**Problem 2** (*Ross Chapter 2 11.8*)

Use Definition 10.6 and Exercise 5.4 to prove  $\liminf s_n = -\limsup(-s_n)$  for every sequence  $(s_n)$ .

**Discussion.****10.6 Definition:**

Let  $(s_n)$  be a sequence in  $\mathbb{R}$ . We define:

$$\limsup s_n = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \sup\{s_n : n > N\}$$

and

$$\liminf s_n = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \inf\{s_n : n > N\}$$

**5.4 Exercise:**

Let  $S$  be a nonempty subset  $\mathbb{R}$ , and let  $-S = -s : s \in S$ . Prove  $\inf S = -\sup(-S)$ . *Hint: For the case  $-\infty < \inf S$ , simply state that this was proved in Exercise 4.9.*

**Proof.**

From the definition of 10.6, we have:

$$\liminf s_n = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \inf\{s_n : n > N\}$$

where we describe the set  $S_N = \{s_n : n > N\}$  such that we can rewrite the expression for  $\liminf(s_n)$  as:

Thus, we have:

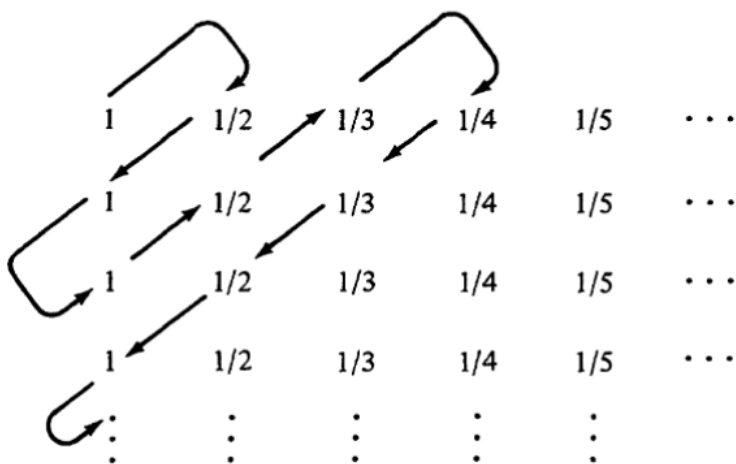
$$\liminf s_n = -\limsup(-s_n)$$

which applies for every sequence  $(s_n)$  since we know the result from Exercise 5.4 holds for any nonempty subset of  $\mathbb{R}$ , and thus every sequence. □

**Problem 3** (*Ross Chapter 2 11.10*)

Let  $(s_n)$  be the sequence of numbers in Fig. 11.2 listed in the indicated order.

- (a) Find the set  $S$  of subsequential limits of  $(s_n)$ .  
 (b) Determine  $\limsup s_n$  and  $\liminf s_n$ .

**FIGURE 11.2**

**Discussion.**

**Proof.**

□

**Problem 4** (*Ross Chapter 2 12.2*)

Prove  $\limsup |s_n| = 0$  if and only if  $\lim s_n = 0$ . **Discussion.**

**Proof.**

□

**Problem 5** (*Ross Chapter 2 12.3*)

Let  $(s_n)$  and  $(t_n)$  be the following sequences that repeat in cycles of four:

$$(s_n) = (0, 1, 2, 1, 0, 1, 2, 1, 0, 1, 2, 1, 0, 1, 2, 1, 0, \dots)$$

$$(t_n) = (2, 1, 1, 0, 2, 1, 1, 0, 2, 1, 1, 0, 2, 1, 1, 0, 2, \dots)$$

Find

- |                                 |                                 |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| (a) $\liminf s_n + \liminf t_n$ | (e) $\limsup s_n + \limsup t_n$ |
| (b) $\liminf(s_n + t_n)$        | (f) $\liminf(s_n t_n)$          |
| (c) $\liminf s_n + \limsup t_n$ | (g) $\limsup(s_n t_n)$          |
| (d) $\limsup(s_n + t_n)$        |                                 |

**Discussion.**

**Proof.**

□

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**Problem 6** (*Ross Chapter 2 12.10*)

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Prove  $(s_n)$  is bounded if and only if  $\limsup |s_n| < +\infty$ .

**Discussion.**

**Proof.**

□